Dire Beginnings

Questbook C:
The Death From Below



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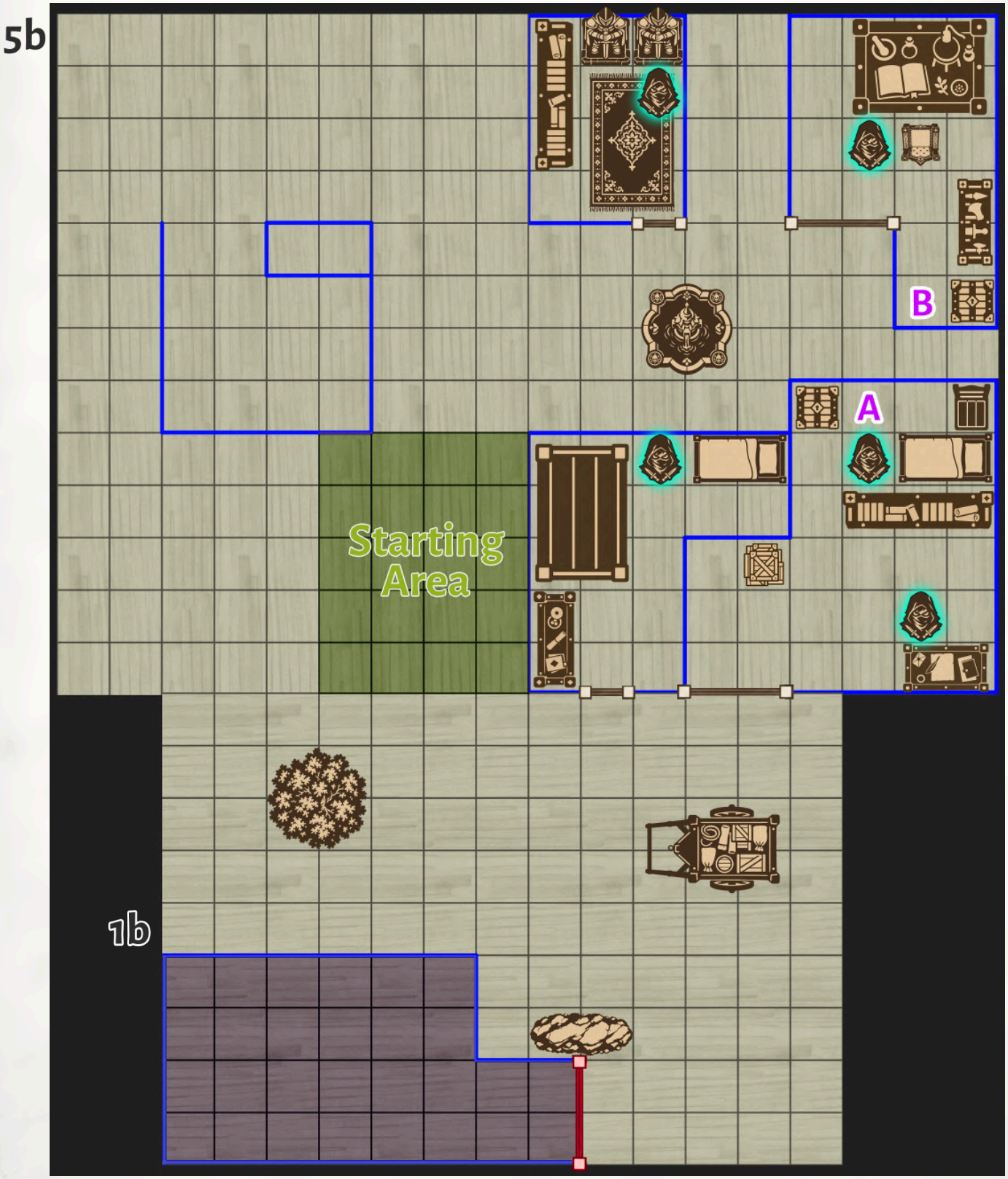
Zombies & Skeletons

In this questbook, if an enemy gains the Zombies or Skeletons trait, their type is additionally considered **Undead**.



Adventure 1C: The Village After Dusk

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 2



Intro

Night finds you in a remote village of Drucavia, little more than crooked roofs, damp fields, and old stone fences pressed against the dark. The villagers offer you shelter in a drafty common house, where the fire burns low and every gust of wind seems to scratch at the shutters.

Before sleep can claim you, the village elder approaches with worry in his eyes. He tells you that a goblin was seen near the old mausoleum, rummaging among the graves and carrying away bones. Since then, strange noises have risen from beneath the burial stones: scraping, muttering, and the sound of something heavy being dragged across the floor.

You gather your weapons and set out toward the mausoleum. But before you reach it, the doors burst open. Orcs and goblins spill into the night, howling for blood, their weapons raised against the unsuspecting village.

Objective

Kill all enemies and keep as many villagers alive as possible.

Starting Conditions

The players can place themselves anywhere in the starting area when the adventure begins.

All regular doors are **open** from the beginning.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	At least 3 Villagers survived.	5	100
★★	At least 1 Villager survived.	5	80
★	The adventure was completed.	4	75

Special Mechanic - Village Defense

Before the adventure begins, divide the Villagers among the heroes. Each Villager is controlled as a minion by the hero who claimed them.

On the adventure layout, Villagers are marked as Bandits. Represent the villagers using peasant and noble standees. Each one has **6 Health**, **5 Speed** and may attack with **2d8 Offense** and **Range 4** - they are equipped with basic crossbows.

Special Mechanic - Orcish Onslaught

Take the following enemy reference cards and shuffle them into one pile:
Goblin, Orc, Ogre

At the beginning of each round, including the first round, draw one random card from this pile. Spawn the listed number of models adjacent to the red locked door, placing them as close to the door as possible:

Orcs = **x 4**
Goblins = **x 7**
Ogres = **x 1**

Once during this adventure, the party may **delay** drawing and spawning an enemy group by one round.

Once all three enemy cards have been drawn, no further groups spawn from Orcish Onslaught.

When the last model of an enemy group is killed, place an objective token on its space. Leave one model from that group on the token as a reminder. This model is inactive, cannot be targeted, and is not treated as a model.

Special Mechanic - Echo of Undeath

Read the following text aloud once all three enemy groups have been defeated:
The last of the attackers falls, and for one brief moment the village is still. Then the corpses begin to tremble.
A cold, hateful energy seeps from the ground and coils around the slain orcs and goblins like black smoke. Broken limbs snap back into place. Dead hands tighten around dropped weapons. Empty eyes open, burning with a pale light. The creatures you killed rise again.
Whatever brought them here is not finished with them.

At the beginning of next round: For each objective token placed by Orcish Onslaught, spawn the listed number of models from that enemy group as close as possible to that token, remove the previous standee that served as a reminder:

Orcs = **x 3**
Goblins = **x 5**
Ogres = **x 1**

All groups share the **Zombies trait** and are additionally considered to be of the **Undead** type.
The adventure ends once all three undead enemy groups have been defeated.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains 25 gold coins.

- B -

The treasure chest contains a Relic: Banner (Executioner's)

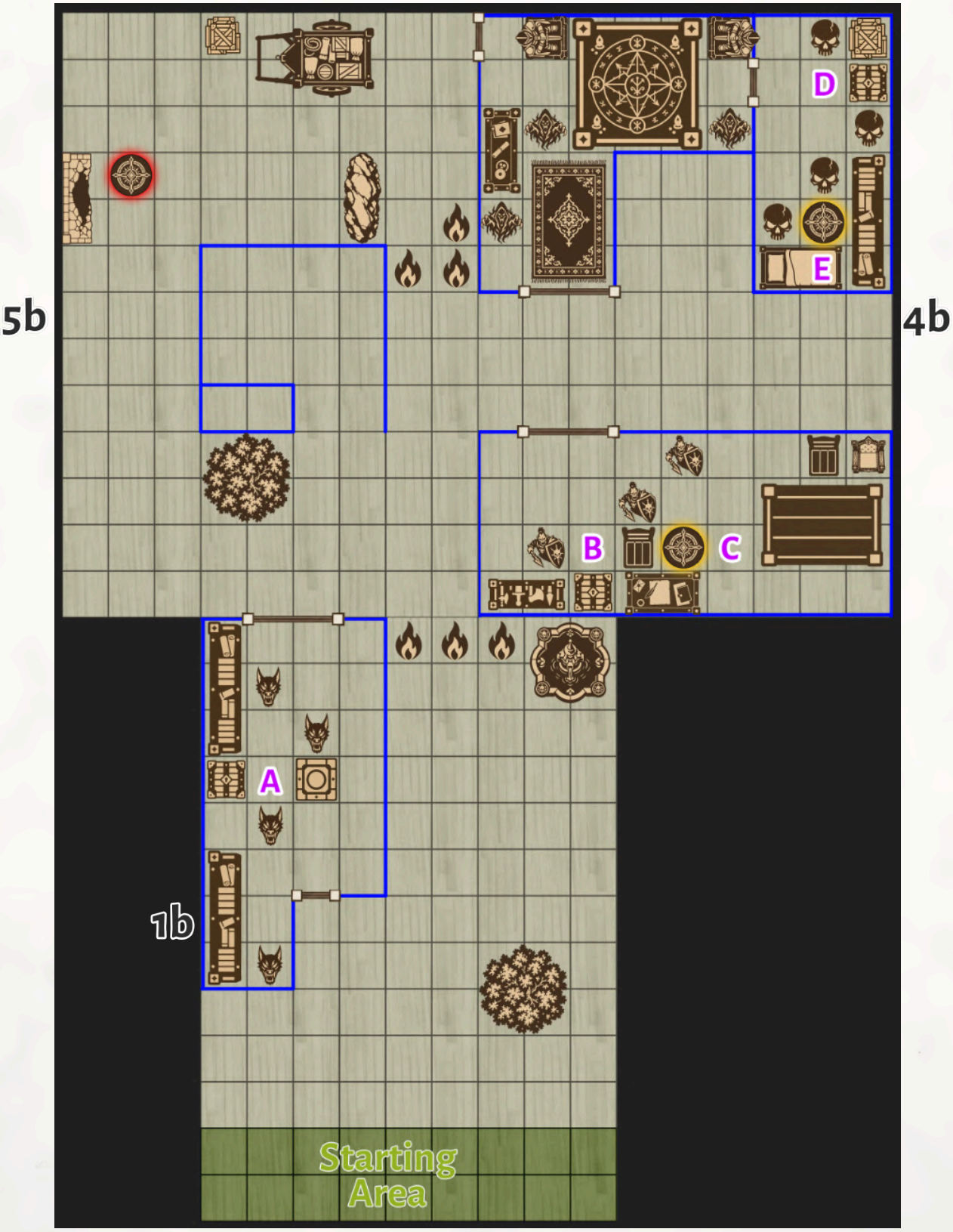
Outro

When the final corpse lies still, silence returns to the village, but peace does not.

The villagers whisper prayers beside shuttered windows, while you look upon the bodies of orcs and goblins that should never have reached this far into Drucavia. Nathender's great walls were built to keep such horrors away. If these raiders passed them, then something has gone terribly wrong.
Worse still is the magic that raised them after death. This was no simple raid. Something was collecting bones. Something was calling the dead back to war. The first answers may lie at the Nathender border.

Adventure 2C: Ash On The Border Road

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

For days, one question follows you like a carrion bird: Did Nathender's great wall truly fail?
The orcs and goblins you slew over the past few days should never have reached so far into Drucavia. If the border has broken, then the realm may soon drown beneath green skin, iron axes, and worse things wearing dead flesh.

On the road north, you meet five travelers bound for Nathender: three peasants with all their lives packed into handcarts, and two weary scouts bearing the colors of the wall-realm. When questioned, one scout spits into the mud and shakes his head.
"The wall still stood ten days ago. I saw it with my own eyes. No breach. No broken gate. No army passing through. Whatever crossed into Drucavia did not come over Nathender's wall."

You offer to escort them home and learn the truth for yourselves.
By dusk, your path leads past a lonely manor, its windows blackened, its fields trampled, its roof still coughing smoke into the evening sky. Corpses lie scattered near the road, some burned, some butchered, some dragged halfway from their homes. Then the silence splits.
From the ruins come shrieking skeletal goblins, their bony hands clutching picks, hooks, and rusted tools. They rush from the smoke with awful hunger, eager to claim the living as fresh corpses.

Objective

Ensure that villagers and Nathender scouts reach the cart.
Optionally collect clues concerning the undead invasion.

Starting Conditions

The players can place themselves and the minions (see special mechanics section) anywhere in the starting area when the adventure begins.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	7 Points* gained.	5	140
★★	6 Points* gained.	4	120
★	At least one villager or scout reached the cart.	3	100

* Gain 1 point for each surviving villager, surviving Nathender scout, and collected clue.

Special Mechanic - Escort

The party must escort three villagers and two Nathender scouts from the starting area to the cart in the north. The adventure ends immediately when every surviving villager and Nathender scout is evacuated. Once a villager or scout ends a movement adjacent to the cart, they are considered safely evacuated. Remove their model from the board.
If all villagers and scouts die, the adventure is lost and no rewards are given.

Represent the Nathender scouts using unused hero standees (e.g. Warrior, Ranger, or Knight).
Each scout has **8 Health**, **5 Speed** and may attack with **2d8 Offense** and **Range 4**.
Each villager has **5 Health, 5 Speed** and may attack with **3d6 Offense** (melee only).

Before the adventure begins, divide the villagers and scouts among the heroes. Each of them is controlled as a minion by the hero who claimed them.

Special Mechanic - Extinguishing Fires

Fire tokens block the most direct route to the cart. A hero who is adjacent to the fountain can spend 1 movement point to gather water. Mark this by placing a Weave token on their hero reference card on the initiative track - a hero can only carry one bucket of water at once.

While adjacent to a fire space, a hero carrying water may spend 1 point of movement and discard their Weave token to remove that fire space. If it is part of a larger fire token, replace the remaining spaces with smaller fire tokens as necessary.

Special Mechanic - Goblin Raid

At the beginning of each round, including the first, spawn **2 Goblins** as close as possible to the red objective near the cart. They have the **Zombies and Fast traits**, but do not gain additional traits based on difficulty.
If the supply of Goblins runs out, advance the Doom Clock by one step for each Goblin skipped this way.

Special Mechanic - Clues

Golden-outlined objective tokens represent optional clues. Collecting them increases the party's reward score but is not required to complete the adventure.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains 20 gold coins.

- B -

The treasure chest contains random contents. Roll 1d6:

1-2: 10 gold coins
3-4: Draw from the item pile until you reveal 2 Consumables.
Gain both Consumables, then shuffle all other revealed cards back into the pile.
5-6: A relic: Rags (Wind-Touched, Stalwart)

- C -

A hero adjacent to this objective token may spend 1 Stamina to collect the clue.
Remove the token and read the following aloud:
You find the writings of a dead mage, the ink smeared by ash, blood, and trembling hands.

I no longer believe this to be mere necromancy.

Something beneath us dreams with open eyes. Something that was never meant to wake, yet can never truly sleep. The undeath we observe may be no spell at all, but one of its thoughts made real. A dead idea, given shape. A nightmare that has learned to walk.

The orcs are only the first vessels. Soon it will dream of men. Then soldiers. Then kings. If we do not find this buried mind and kill it, the realm itself may become an army for the thing that must never wake.

I pray this theory is madness. I fear it is not.

- D -

The treasure chest in this room contains a tome that grants one hero +1 to any one of their ability limits for the rest of the campaign (e.g. Arcane, Combat etc.). Choose the recipient and category during town phase.

- E -

A hero adjacent to this objective token may spend 1 Stamina to collect the clue.
Remove the token and read the following aloud:
In one ruined bedroom, you find a peasant lying dead beneath a woolen blanket, his face twisted in silent terror. At first, there is no sign of violence. Then you pull the blanket aside.
Runic markings crawl across his skin, carved or burned into the flesh in crooked patterns. They resemble the symbols you saw on the dead orcs, though these are less certain, less complete. Some lines stop abruptly. Others overlap, as if corrected by an impatient hand. This corpse does not rise.

Whatever power animated the orcs may have reached for this man and failed. Perhaps the evil behind this invasion is still learning how to turn human corpses into obedient soldiers.
Or perhaps this was only an early attempt.

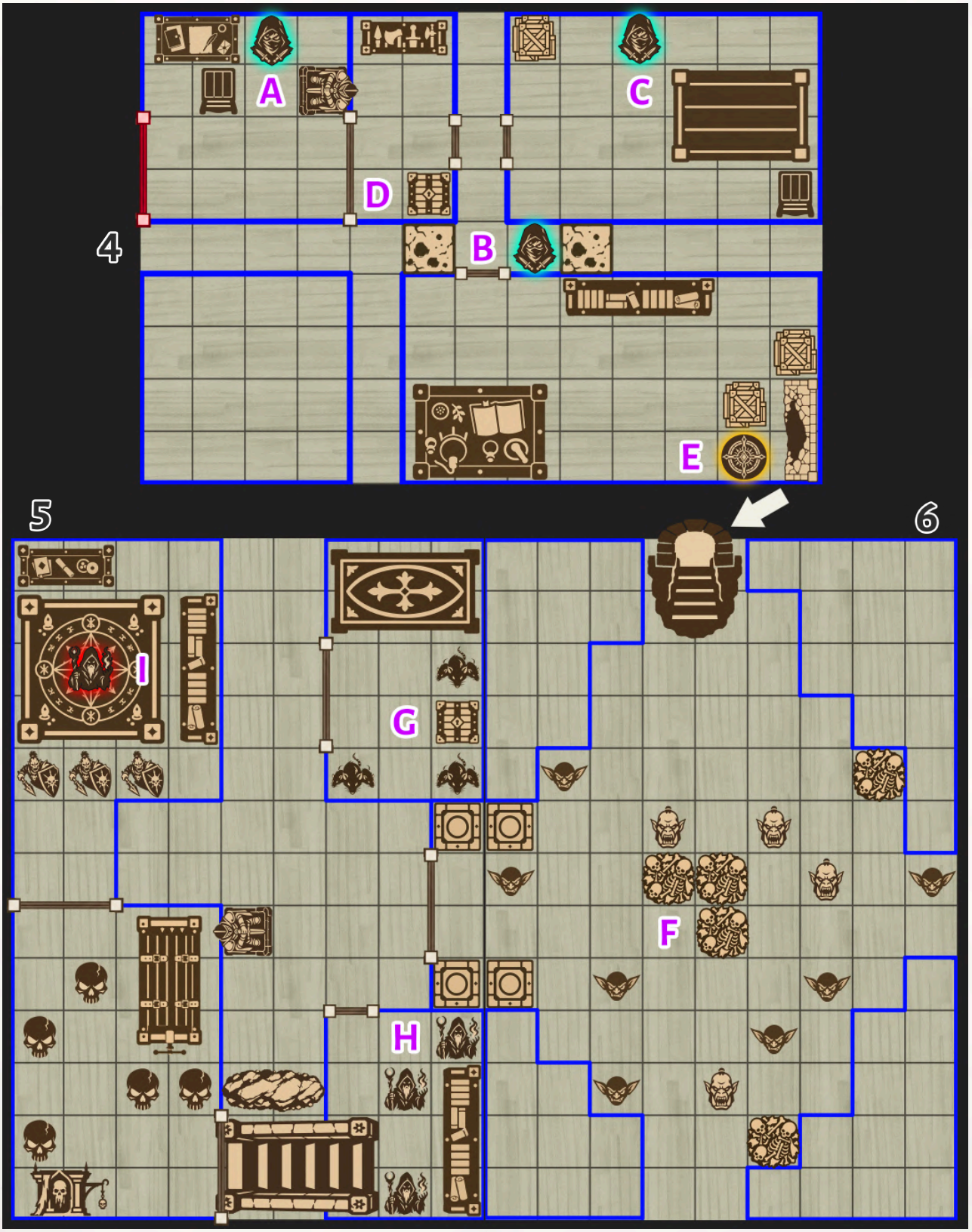
Outro

With the manor cleared and the dead given what little peace you can offer, you continue west with the surviving travelers.
Crossing into Nathender feels almost unreal. In Drucavia, corruption has spread like mold through the bones of the realm: burned farms, frightened villages, broken roads, and nobles hiding behind locked gates. But Nathender still stands in stern order. Its fields are tended. Its watch posts are manned. Its roads are muddy, but not abandoned.

The contrast unsettles you more than ruin might have.
In the nearest city, you pause only long enough to gather provisions and hear the same answer from every soldier, merchant, and priest: the great wall has not fallen. So you press onward.
Somewhere ahead, Nathender's colossal border wall cuts across the horizon. If the orcs did not come through it, then the truth must lie beneath it.

Adventure 3C: The Wall Still Stands

Starting Doom Clock: 10
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

For almost an entire day, you have searched the great wall of Nathender.
You have walked beneath its shadow, questioned its sentries, studied its gates, and inspected the stonework from both sides. No breach reveals itself. No ruined tower. No hidden pass. The wall stands as Nathender swore it did: vast, grim, and unbroken.

Only once did something disturb the order of it all. A smell. Brief, foul, and unmistakable. Rotten flesh, carried on a thin breath of air from somewhere within the wall itself.

Night has fallen by the time you make one final attempt to find its source. A nearby guardhouse grants you entry into the inner passages of the wall. Inside, everything seems as it should. Torches burn in iron brackets. Boots strike stone in disciplined rhythm. Nathender's defenders stand at their posts with weary pride, nodding as you pass.

Still, somewhere beneath the clean stone and ordered watch, the stink of death waits.

Objective

Investigate the Nathender Wall and find the source of Undeath. Destroy it if you find anything.

Starting Conditions

Heroes are not placed on the dungeon entrance, but instead as close as possible to the red locked door.

The game board is divided into two sections, and the lower bigger section is not accessible initially.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion.	5	130
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	4	110
★	Adventure completed.	3	90

Special Mechanic - Nathender Defenders

The bandits with a teal-colored outline represent defenders serving at the Great Wall of Nathender.
They can be recruited to aid in the party's investigation. If successful, they become a minion for the hero who succeeded in convincing them. You can **only attempt once** at convincing each defender.

Adventure Overview

- A -

Julienne is a **Knight** (use a suitable unused hero standee to represent her).

To convince her to join, a hero can attempt to impress her with a feat of power.
While adjacent, **spend X Stamina**, and roll 1d6 for each point of Stamina spent.
If the roll has 2 or more successes against 4+, she successfully becomes a minion.

Julienne has **8 Health, 6 Speed**, **Armor 5+** and may attack with **3d6 Offense** (melee only).

- B -

Drougbart is a **Ranger** (use a suitable unused hero standee to represent him).

To convince him to join, a hero can attempt to charm him.
While adjacent, **spend 1 Stamina and roll 2d6, plus another d6 for every Charisma trait slot that hero has.**
If the roll has 1 or more successes against 4+, he successfully becomes a minion.

Drougbart has **7 Health, 7 Speed**, and may attack with **2d8 Offense** at **Range 4**.

- C -

Kaleen is a **Mage** (use a suitable unused hero standee to represent them).

To convince them to join, a hero can bribe them.
While adjacent, **spend 1 Stamina and X gold coins. For every 5 gold coins spent, roll 1d6.**
If the roll has 1 or more successes against 3+, they successfully become a minion.

Kaleen has **7 Health, 6 Speed**, and may do **one** of the following during their turn:

Cantrip Missile:	Deals 2 Damage against an enemy in hearing range.
Swift Telekinesis:	Move any one model by 2 spaces.
Mend Injuries:	Heal 2 a minion within Range 3.

Additionally, they can perform one of these spells at half its efficacy at any time, once per round (for example, Cantrip Missile will only deal 1 Damage instead of 2 when used this way).

- D -

The treasure chest contains random contents. Roll 1d6:

1-2: 10 gold coins
3-4: Draw from the item pile until you reveal 2 Consumables.
Gain both Consumables, then shuffle all other revealed cards back into the pile.
5-6: Round Shield or 40 gold coins.

- E -

A hero adjacent to this objective token can spend 1 Stamina token, then read the following text aloud:
The smell leads you to an alchemy kitchen tucked into a quiet corner of the wall-fort. Dried herbs hang from the ceiling. Glass vessels crowd the shelves. Crates, sacks, and old barrels have been stacked carelessly against the rear wall. Behind them, you find it.
A hole, half-hidden in the masonry, breathing the reek of rotten flesh into the room.
As one of you leans closer to inspect it, the stone gives way beneath their feet. With a shout, they vanish into darkness, sliding down a steep shaft of packed earth, broken brick, and old bone. The fall ends in a wide underground tunnel.
The air below is colder, fouler, and thick with grave dust. Around you lie heaps of bones, some ancient and yellowed, others still wet with scraps of flesh. Then the piles begin to shift.

Skeletal goblins claw themselves free from the piles. Orc bones drag themselves upright, dead hands closing around rusted weapons. Hollow eyes re-ignite with pale hunger.

Whatever lies beneath the wall has guards of its own.

The hero who just interacted with the token is placed on the Dungeon Entrance on the second board section. From now on, heroes and minions can move onto the objective token which will bring them to any one space of the Dungeon Entrance, or as close as possible.

- F -

All enemies in this room have the **Skeletons trait**.

- G -

The treasure chest contains a Relic: War Javelins (Mastercrafted, Infusing).

- H -

The Evil Wizards in this room have the **Zombies and Enduring traits**.

- I -

When this room is entered, read the following text aloud:
You enter a chamber where the stones have been carved with old runes and fresh wounds.
At its center stands an undead sorcerer, its withered hands raised above a ritual circle cut into the floor.
Cold light flickers between the markings. Within that light, a faint portal takes shape.
For a moment, you see beyond Nathender's wall.
Dark trees. Ancient roots. The savage depths of the Leyforest, where orc tribes still roam beyond the reach of civilized realms. The lich turns its empty gaze toward the vision, as if choosing from a herd.
This is no simple passage. This is a hunting window. A spell to reach past the wall, seize new victims, and drag them into the depths, where death can make them useful.

The **Evil Wizard** in this room is a a **Lich** and is a **boss**. See the reference table on the next page.
When he dies, the adventure ends.



Property	Description / Value
Health	45
Defense	3+
Speed	3 (**2** *after factoring in the Skeleton trait)*
Attacks	2 (**3** *after factoring in the Skeleton trait)*
Damage	6
Range	-
Passives	Undead, Immune to **Stun and Daze**.
Traits	Legendary, Skeleton, Sorcerous
Minor Ability	**Necrotic Blast:** At the end of his turn, he causes Blast 2 around him that only targets heroes. Heroes struck also suffer Knockback 2.
Major Ability	***Lich Magic*** At the end of his turns, roll 1d6 and execute an ability based on the roll. **1-2: Rotting Flesh** All heroes and minions within Range 5 suffer Decay 2. Heroes or minions with 4 or less Health remaining suffer Decay 1 instead. **3-4: Primal Fear** Every hero within hearing range rolls 2d6 against 5+. Heroes add +1d6 for every Wisdom trait slot they have. If at least 1 success was rolled, nothing happens. On a failure, that hero suffers 1 Fatigue and must immediately Move 4 away from the Lich. **5-6: Sudden Army** Creates five Undead as close as possible to him. They act in the same round, but are removed at the end of it. For every Undead killed before they collapse automatically, the Lich loses 4 Health.

Outro

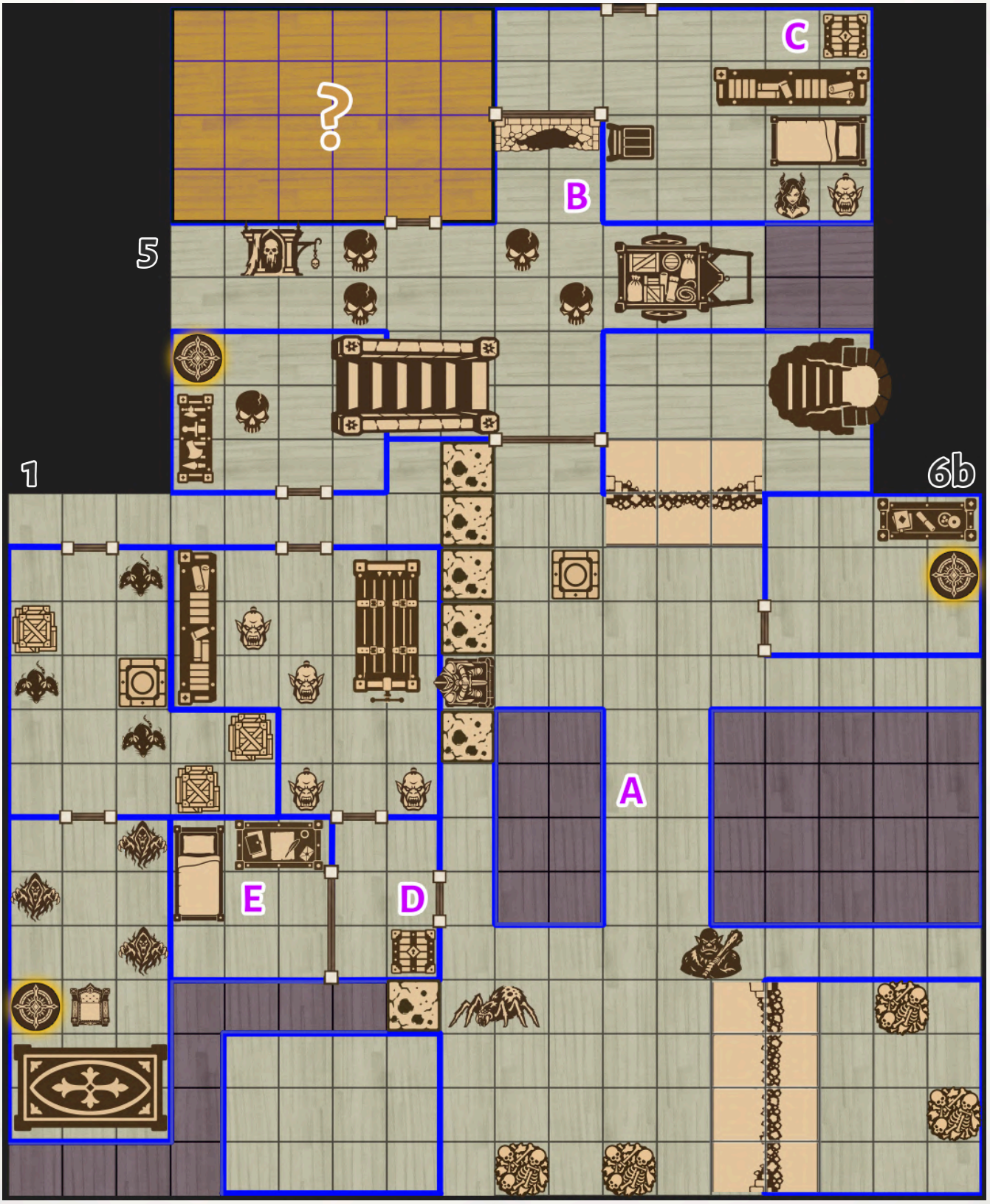
When the ritual chamber falls silent, the truth begins to take shape.
Nathender's wall did not fail. It was bypassed. Dark magic has been opening paths beyond the wall, dragging orcs from the Leyforest and delivering them into the steep tunnel system beneath the border. From there, the invaders could emerge behind Nathender's defenses, or slip onward into Drucavia like poison through buried veins.
As you search farther, the scale of the threat becomes clearer.

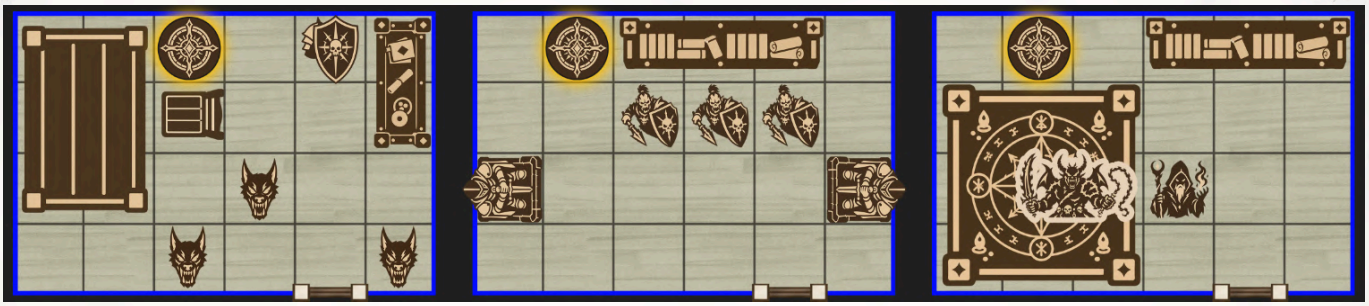
These are not a few hidden passages beneath one guardhouse. The tunnels run deeper and wider than any recent map suggests. Some are old military roads between Nathender and Drucavia. Others bear the marks of forgotten dwarven craft: broad stonework, collapsed railways, sealed gates, and stairways descending into cities whose names no human kingdom remembers.

The enemy has found a buried world, and somewhere within it, its source must meet your justice.

Adventure 4C: The Ossuary Road

Starting Doom Clock: 2*
Resurrection Boons: 1





Intro

The tunnels beneath Nathender do not end at the wall.
They spread like buried veins beneath the borderlands, old roads and broken dwarven passages now claimed by the dead. From these depths, undead goblin sappers have been reaching the surface again and again, striking at Drucavian farms, roads, and watch posts before vanishing back below.
After days of following tracks, collapsed shafts, and the stench of grave-magic, you have found what may be one of the lich's crucial underground hubs: a main road used by the undead to move troops and supplies beneath the realm.
You descend with a handful of brave soldiers, knowing the task before you is dangerous, but simple. Somewhere ahead lies a narrow bridge spanning a deep chasm. If destroyed, it could slow the undead advance and buy Drucavia precious time. The goblin sappers have been using powder kegs in their raids. If you can find enough of them below, you may turn the enemy's own tools against them.
Steel is drawn. Torches are lit. Then you march into the dark road beneath the earth.

Objective

Destroy the bridge using powder kegs, and prevent Goblin sappers from reaching the surface.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	No more than 2 Sappers reached the surface.	5	175
★★	No more than 4 Sappers reached the surface.	4	160
★	The Bridge was destroyed.	4	130

Special Mechanic - Powder Kegs

To destroy the bridge, **four powder kegs** must be found and placed on it.

Powder kegs do not block movement or line of sight.

When a hero is adjacent to one (represented by objective tokens), they can spend 1 Stamina to pick it up - place the objective token on that hero's reference card.

For each Powder Keg carried, the speed of that hero is decreased by 1.

Dropping the powder keg underneath that hero can be done for free at any time, but a maximum of one powder keg can occupy a given space.

Special Mechanic - Goblin Sappers

During this adventure, the Doom Clock increases instead of decreasing.
Therefore ignore Doom Clock limit increases from campaign quests.

At the beginning of each round, **except** the first, increase the Doom Clock by +1.
Also at the beginning of each round, **including** the first, spawn a number of Goblins adjacent to the bone piles equal to the Doom Clock - distribute them as evenly between the bone piles as possible. They have the **Skeletons, Cowardly and Incompetent traits**. Do **not** add random traits to them based on difficulty.

For each Goblin you have to skip spawning, due to having reached the supply limit, the Goblin furthest from the Dungeon Entrance moves 4 spaces with **Nimble** towards it.
Re-evaluate the target after each move.

These Goblins use **all movement** across the bridge and towards the Dungeon Entrance. As soon as a Goblin enters its space, remove them - they have successfully escaped to the surface to cause chaos within Drucavia!
Track their number to evaluate the adventure rewards.

Special Mechanic - Brave Soldiers

The party is accompanied by brave volunteering soldiers. Distribute their ownership among the party as you please. The party can spend **12 Army Points** to assemble this group of minions - unspent points are lost:

Soldier Type	Army Point Cost	Stats & Abilities
Melee Soldier	2	6 Health, 6 Speed, 4d6 Offense.
Crossbow Soldier	2	4 Health, 4 Speed, 3d8 Offense at Range 7.
Militia	1	1 Health, 5 Speed, 4d6 Offense at Range 4.
Court Priest	3	6 Health, 5 Speed, 4d6 Offense at Range 6. Can forfeit its attack to instead Heal 5 a minion within Range 5.
Court Mage	3*	5 Health, 4 Speed, 2d8 Offense at Range 5. Their attacks cause **Blast 1** if successful. ** Can get a maximum of 2 Court Mages.*

Once the composition of soldiers is determined, use appropriate standees to represent them, for example villagers for Militia or unused hero standees.



Adventure Overview

- A -

This is the bridge. Powder kegs must be placed on any of its 8 spaces.

- B -

Once a hero is standing next to the broken wall, read the following text aloud:
The wall ahead is crude work: loose stones, damp mortar, and enough cracks to suggest that a determined shoulder might bring it down. As you brace yourself to smash through, you hear sounds from the chamber beyond. A low orcish grunt. A woman's breathy laugh. The scrape of armor being pushed aside. Whatever is happening in there, it does not sound like a guard post at attention.
The wall still looks weak. But perhaps bursting through now would make for an especially awkward ambush.

A hero adjacent to the broken wall can spend **1 Stamina** and roll 2d6. They add +1d6 for each Strength trait slot they have. If they have at least 1 success against 4+, remove the broken wall prop and open the door behind it. If the hero fails, they suffer the "Broken Shoulder" injury. If that injury is already in play, they lose 3 health instead.

- C -

The treasure chest contains a cursed but extremely powerful item. Draw from the pile of items until you have revealed three level VII items. Keep one and discard the other two. The item can never be sold - and the first hero to equip it will be forced to keep it equipped in its corresponding slot - they cannot take it off for the remainder of this campaign run!

- D -

The treasure chest contains random contents. Roll 1d6:

1-2: 15 gold coins
3-4: Obtain a random **Epic** affix. Draw from the pile until it shows an **Epic** affix. You may then apply it to any item in the party's possession.
5-6: A tome of training: during the next town phase, declare a category of abilities (e.g. Combat, Arcane etc.). Then add **all** abilities of that category to the Ability Display of that town phase.

- E -

As soon as the door to this room has been opened, read the following text aloud:
The locked cell groans open, its hinges stiff with rust and neglect.
Inside, you find a dwarf chained against a bed, half-starved, filthy, and surrounded by the stale stink of old wounds. For a moment, he looks more ghost than prisoner. Then his eyes focus.
He sees weapons. He sees enemies. He sees a path out.
With a harsh laugh, the dwarf drags himself upright as if spite alone has put strength back into his bones. Once freed of his chains, he snatches up the nearest weapon and rolls his shoulders.
"Rotting in a hole was getting dull," he growls. "Point me at the bastards who built it."
The prisoner joins the fight.

For the duration of this adventure, the Dwarf is considered a melee soldier (see special mechanics).
If he is killed, he returns on that space (or closest to it) at the beginning of next round with 1 Health.
Use the Man-At-Arms standee (from his unlock box) to represent him.

The **Man-At-Arms class is now permanently considered unlocked**.

Mid-Campaign Swap

During the next Town Phase, one player may replace their current hero with the Man-at-Arms. Before doing so, they must sell or distribute all of their current hero's equipment and return all cards and components belonging to that hero to the box.

The player then takes all components belonging to the Man-at-Arms and sets him up as though beginning a new campaign. The Man-at-Arms immediately gains XP equal to the total amount earned by the previous hero, including any XP that hero had already spent.

The player may also examine the top 20 Ability cards and the top 10 Trait cards. These cards form a private display available only to that player. They may learn cards from this display and may still participate in the party's regular display.

After the swap, resolve all future Town Phases as normal.

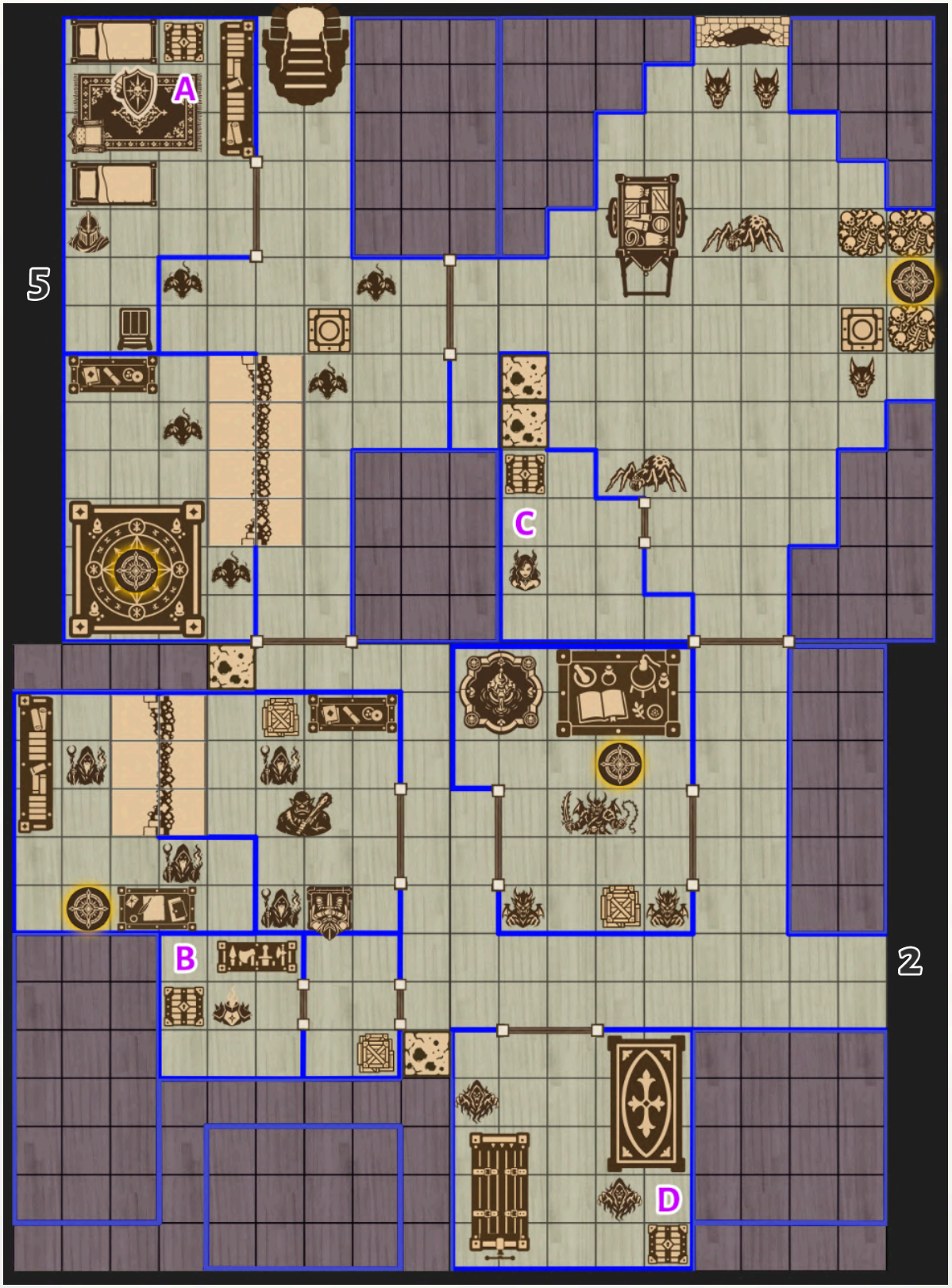
Important: If no player chooses to play the Man-at-Arms during the next Town Phase, the party instead receives the **Dwarven Battleaxe** from the dwarf as a token of gratitude.

Outro

You retreat back toward the surface with the surviving soldiers, bruised, soot-stained, and half-deaf from the work done below.
For a while, there is only waiting. Then the ground answers.
A thunderous explosion tears through the depths beneath you. The earth heaves. Distant trees shudder.
Somewhere far below, stone collapses into stone, and part of the buried road swallows itself in a roar of dust and broken masonry.
The undead will not stop forever. But they will be slowed down.
As the echoes fade, one of the soldiers approaches and unfolds a crude map taken from a goblin sapper. Its lines are ugly, scratched in charcoal and blood, but the meaning is clear enough: the underground network is larger than feared. Several routes are marked, along with strange symbols for gates, pits, barracks, and supply paths.
One mark stands out from the rest.
A jagged symbol, drawn beside what looks like an anvil or furnace.
The soldier taps it with a grimy finger.
"Whatever that is," he mutters, "the goblins thought it important."

Adventure 5C: The Corpse-Forge

Starting Doom Clock: 12
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

The crude map taken from the goblin sapper leads you deeper than any road was ever meant to go.

For hours, you follow its ugly charcoal lines through buried passages, collapsed halls, and old dwarven stonework blackened by age. Along the way, you find one more gift from the enemy: an abandoned sapper cart, its wheels barely intact, its boards scorched, and its bed loaded with powder kegs and bundled explosive charges.

The goblins meant to use them against the surface. You have a better purpose in mind.
Far below, the tunnels widen into a furnace-lit cavern. There, amid chains, hooks, and vats of pale alchemical fire, stand the corpse-forges. Dead orcs are dragged into them as broken meat and hauled out again as armored horrors, stitched with iron, bone, and hateful magic. Goblins scurry between the forges, chanting, hammering, and feeding the machines of undeath.

If these places keep burning, the lich's army will only grow stronger.
You ready the explosives and descend into the forge.

Objective

Destroy at least three corpse-forges, then slay Bromm the Corpse-Smith.

Starting Conditions

Place the heroes, cart and chosen minions as close as possible to the dungeon entrance, in any order.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion.	5	160
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	5	140
★	Adventure completed.	4	130

Special Mechanic - The Captured Cart

During this adventure, use a Plague Ossuary standee to represent the captured cart. It is a special objective element that behaves like a Big model, but cannot be targeted. A hero adjacent to it can spend **1 Stamina** to grant the cart **Move 2**. Any minion adjacent to it can forfeit its standard attack to achieve the same **Move 2**.

When the cart is within **Range 2** of an objective, a hero who is adjacent to said objective token can spend **2 Stamina** to take explosives off the cart and place them onto the objective token (see next section).

To support the party of heroes, the players can assemble a group of minions with the same rules as **"Brave Soldiers"** of the adventure "The Ossuary Road". But this time there are only **6 Army Points** available.

Special Mechanic - The Corpse-Forges & Explosives

When a hero has put explosives onto an objective token, place 2 Decay tokens on it. At the beginning of each round, one of them is removed. When the last Decay token is removed, the explosives go off!
That forge is destroyed - remove the objective token.
Every model within **Range 8** of the objective token **loses 5 Health** and - in case of heroes - suffers an **injury**. The cart remains unaffected by this. After all, it is armored and secured enough.

Remember that once **three out of four forges** have been destroyed, Bromm the Corpse-Smith appears.

Special Mechanic - Bromm the Corpse-Smith

Once three forges have been destroyed, Bromm the Corpse-Smith becomes aware of the intrusion. He is a **bespoke boss** and spawns adjacent to any one hero - the party chooses.
He gains the **Brutal, Powerful and Cowardly traits**.

Bromm has two phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Bone Armor, Charge, Corpse Ascension

Phase 2

Charge, Crushing Strike, Injuring Stab
Add **Flailing Strike** when playing at **campaign difficulty 4+**.

Read the following text aloud as he appears:
A deep rumble rolls through the forge, loud enough to shake dust from the ceiling. Then something roars.
A reinforced door bursts from its hinges, crashing across the stone in a storm of splinters and iron. Through the opening lumbers a massive figure, broad as an ogre and stitched together from slabs of dead flesh, blackened armor, and furnace-scorched skin. Its hands are huge, its shoulders hunched, its eyes glow like the embers of a forge. The creature looks upon the ruined devices, then upon you. Its rage fills the cavern like a struck bell.
With a butcher's howl, the corpse-smith charges.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains a random **Epic** affix.
Draw from the pile of affixes until you have two. Then choose one of the two affixes to apply it to an item of the party's choice.

- B -

The treasure chest contains a Relic: Flow Talisman (Infusing, Stalwart).

- C -

The treasure chest contains a power focus. During the next town phase, one hero permanently gains an additional trait slot (type: flex) for the remainder of the campaign.

- D -

The treasure chest here contains a tome that grants one hero +1 to any one of their ability limits for the rest of the campaign (e.g. Arcane, Combat etc.). Choose the recipient and category during town phase.

Outro

When the final forge collapses, the cavern becomes a grave of smoke, sparks, and broken runic machinery.

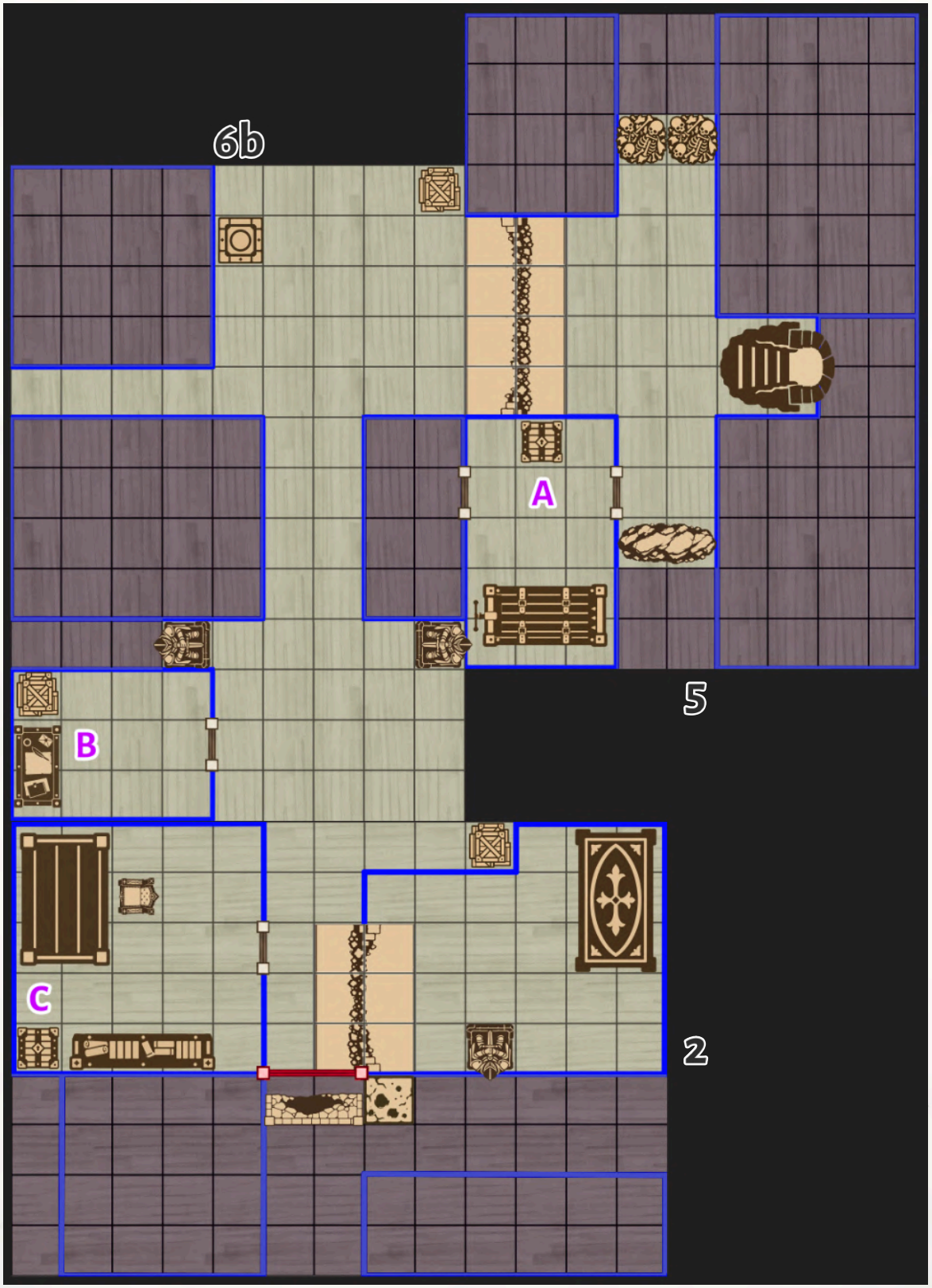
Among the wreckage, you find one survivor: a human cultist, trembling beneath an overturned workbench, his robes stained with grease, blood, and corpse-ash. He is no undead thing. Only a frightened apprentice who served the corpse-smith and now sees no master left to protect him. It does not take long before fear loosens his tongue. He tells you the forges were only one part of a greater mustering. The lich's army is already moving through the deep roads: undead orcs, goblin sappers, ogre brutes, dead soldiers, and worse things dragged from older darkness. Their destination is not a village, a border fort, or some nameless stretch of farmland.

They march for Thornwater, the capital of Drucavia.

The cultist swears the army is vast enough to leave nothing but a wasteland when it is done with the city. You leave the corpse-forge in ruins, but the war has moved ahead of you.

Adventure 6C: The Army Below

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

Your warning reaches Thornwater before the dead do.

At court, you speak plainly: the lich's army is moving through the deep roads, and if it reaches the capital from below, walls and gates will mean little. King Arnewald gives the order to muster every soldier he can spare. Messengers ride hard through the city, calling for barricades, watchfires, sealed cellars, and armed patrols in every district.

But defense alone will not be enough.

While Thornwater prepares above, you descend below with a force of the king's bravest men. Your path leads through ancient dwarven halls once connected to Drucavia in forgotten days: broad corridors of carved stone, collapsed galleries, cracked pillars, and old roads swallowed by dust.

Then you hear it. A rhythm in the dark. Boots. Bones. Iron. Claws. The marching of the dead rolls through the buried halls like distant thunder. The soldiers around you tighten their grips and whisper final prayers. Somewhere ahead, the undead host is coming.

There is no time left to delay them. You raise your weapons, and the king's men raise theirs beside you. The battle of your lives begins beneath Thornwater.

Objective

Survive the wave of enemies without dying.
The adventure cannot be completed until the **Relentless Onslaught** pile is empty, the lieutenant has appeared, and all enemies spawned through **Relentless Onslaught** have been defeated.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 2+ upon completion.	5	180
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion.	5	160
★	Adventure survived.	4	150

Special Mechanic - The King's Men

To support the party of heroes, the players can assemble a group of minions with the same rules as **"Brave Soldiers"** of the adventure "The Ossuary Road". But this time there are **15 Army Points** available.

As soon as the **Doom Clock reaches 4**, the party immediately gains another **6 Army Points** to allocate - these new minions appear on the Dungeon Entrance. These points can only be spent to replace already fallen minions. Count the value of Army Points that have been lost up to this point, and use that as a limitation against the additional 6 Army Points granted.

It is advised to place any kind of marker or token on Doom Clock position 4 as a reminder.

Special Mechanic - Relentless Onslaught

Any enemies spawning during this adventure share the **Zombies trait**, and all enemies are considered to be of the **Undead type** instead of what is written on their reference card.

Take the following enemy reference cards and shuffle them into a pile:
Goblins, Orcs, Corpsebound Legionaries, Ogre, Plague Ossuary, Evil Wizard, Bandit, Giant Spider, Wraith and Corrupted.

At the beginning of each round, including the first, **draw 2 random enemy cards** and spawn a number of models based on its type adjacent to the red locked door. Place them as close as possible.
If there were already 3 or more enemy groups active, draw only 1 card instead.

Enemy	# of Models
Goblins	8
Orcs	5
Corpsebound Leg.	3
Ogre	2
Plague Ossuary	1

Enemy	# of Models
Evil Wizard	4
Bandit	5
Giant Spider	2
Wraith	4
Corrupted	5

If you would have to draw another enemy card but there are none left in the pre-assembled pile, one last lieutenant appears to join the fray. Use the Fallen Hero, but treat this as a **boss**. In addition to also being a **Zombie** like all other enemies, roll a **d8** to determine their exact identity and abilities - the **major ability is overridden** accordingly.
In each case, the lieutenant has **60 Health**. The d8 table is on the following page.



D8	Lieutenant	Bonus Traits	Major Ability
1-2	**Dormos, The Defiler**	Sorcerous Legendary Tough To Kill	Roll a **d6** at the end of his turns: 1-2: **Rotten Exhalation** - The closest hero within Range 5 suffers Daze. Then each minion adjacent to that hero loses 2 Health. 3-4: **Carrion Bloom** - Each hero within Range 3 of Dormos suffers 4 damage. Then Dormos gains Heal 3 for each hero successfully hit. 5-6: **Defiler's Blessing** - All enemies, including Dormos, cause Decay 1 with every default attack, successful or not. Lasts until Dormos' beginning of next turn.
3-4	**Varkun Iron-Cairn**	Leader Legendary Armored	Roll a **d6** at the end of his turns: 1-2: **Shield Wall** - Until the end of the next round, all Undead-type enemies within Range 2 of Varkun gain Resilient 2, including him. 3-4: **Dead March** - All enemies immediately Move 4 towards the Dungeon Entrance. 5-6: **Iron Challenge** - The closest hero within Range 6 suffers "Marked by Varkun". Until the end of the next round, every enemy deals +1 damage against that hero. Use a damage or weave token on the hero standee as a reminder.
5-6	**Nib the Sapper**	Skilled Legendary Dangerous	Roll a **d6** at the end of his turns: 1-2: **Smoke and Screeching:** Each hero within Range 4 suffers Daze. 3-4: **Powder Keg:** Mark the space below the furthest hero or minion within Range 4. At the beginning of Nib's next turn, cause Blast 8 on that space's location. 5-6: **Worthy Sacrifice** - Nib targets one enemy within hearing range that has the least amount of health left - cannot target Nib. That enemy Moves 2 to become adjacent to as many heroes and minions as possible. It is then killed, causing Blast 6.
7-8	**Serapha Mournveil**	Sorcerous Legendary Cowardly	Roll a **d6** at the end of his turns: 1-2: **Hollow Command:** All models of the closest other enemy group Move 4 toward the hero with the least amount of remaining health. 3-4: **Stolen Breath:** The furthest hero within Range 6 must banish 2 abilities. 5-6: **Borrowed Corpse:** The first enemy model that is defeated before Serapha's next turn immediately returns. If has damage equal to half its health, rounded up. This cannot affect Serapha.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains a power focus. During the next town phase, one hero permanently gains an additional trait slot (type: flex) for the remainder of the campaign.

- B -

A hero standing on this spot can study the Dwarven writings by spending 2 Stamina.
Then they roll 1d6 and add +1d6 for each Wisdom trait slot they have. If they have at least 1 success against 4+, they may draw cards from the ability deck until they have revealed **five Divine abilities**.
They may choose one of them. It can be used during this adventure as a spell scroll. The hero must use it during one of their turns, but they use it at no cost. Then that ability goes back into the ability deck.
The hero can repeat the check until they succeed. After that, there are no more writings left to study.

- C -

The treasure chest contains a random **Epic** affix.
Draw from the pile of affixes until you have two. Then choose one of the two affixes to apply it to an item of the party's choice.

Outro

At last, the buried hall falls silent.

The onslaught is broken. Most of the undead host lies scattered across the stone in heaps of bone, rusted armor, and rotten flesh. Those that escaped are leaderless, broken, and scattered into the dark. You can only trust that the king's army on the surface will be ready to destroy whatever remains.

As the soldiers tend to their wounded, a familiar figure steps carefully among the corpses.

Sitilius Morcant, court mage of Drucavia, lowers himself beside the fallen lieutenant and studies the marks carved into their dead flesh. His expression is grave, but not fearful. With gentle hands, he traces the runes in the air above them, murmuring words that make the torchlight bend.

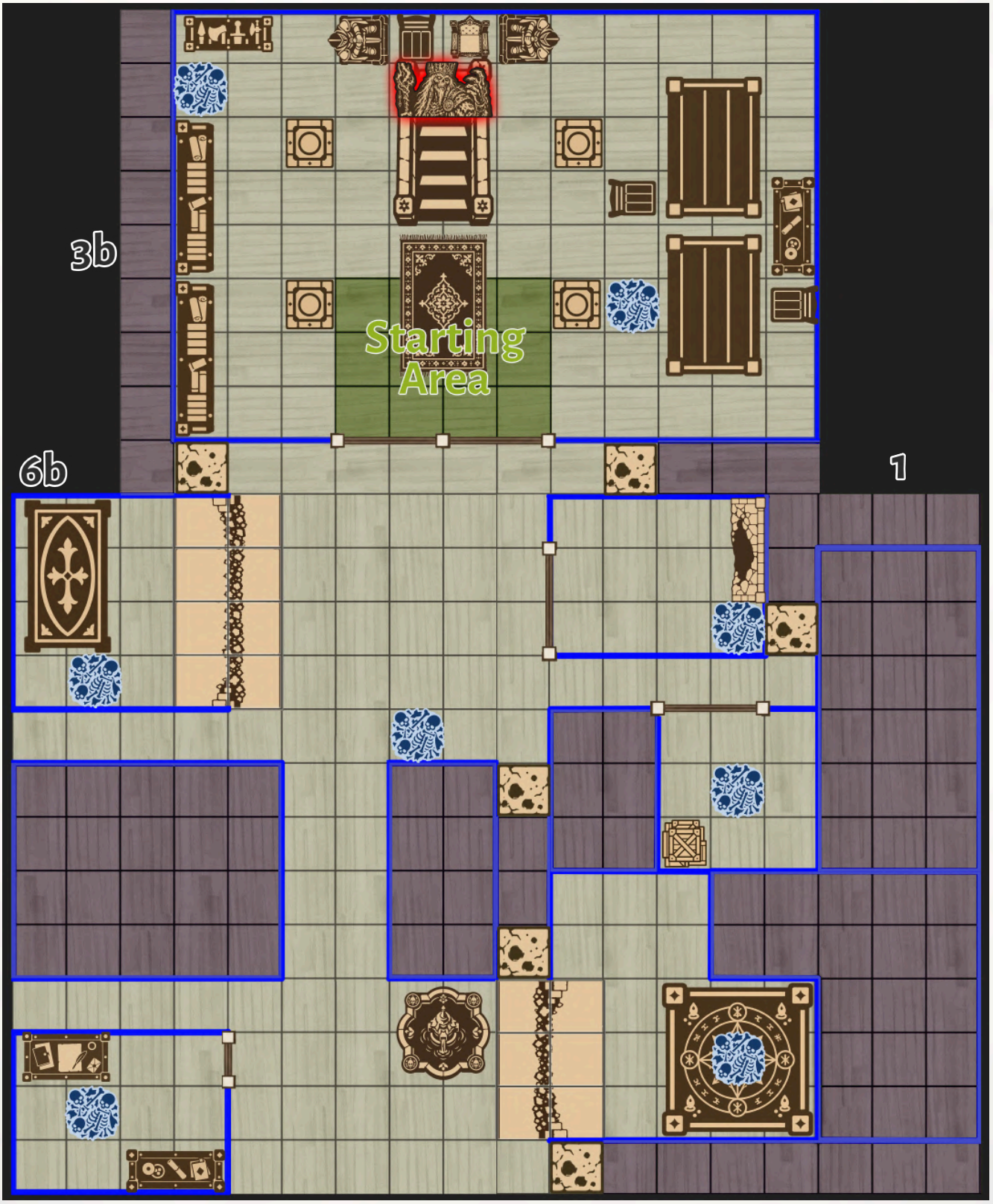
"There is a thread here," he says softly. "Not command alone. Creation. These creatures were bound to the one who made them."

He closes his eyes. For a moment, the air grows cold. Then Sitilius turns toward a dark passage leading deeper into the old dwarven halls. "The thread leads that way," he says. "To a place older than this kingdom, and long forgotten by living men. If my reading is true, then the lich himself waits there."

He looks to you, sorrow and resolve mingling in his eyes.
"You have severed his army. Now you must end its master."

Adventure 7C: The Throne Underneath

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 2



Intro

Guided by Sitilius Morcant's reading of the dead lieutenants, you descend deeper into the old dwarven ways.

The passages become grander as you travel, though age and death have gnawed at every stone. Pillars carved with forgotten kings stand cracked in the dark. Broken statues watch you pass with blind gemstone eyes. At last, the path opens into a vast throne hall buried beneath the world.

Here, Varkul the Below-King has made his court. The ancient throne of a dwarven ruler rises at the far end of the chamber, half-swallowed by bone, corpse-flesh, and black iron. Around it lie the dead of many peoples: orcs, goblins, ogres, humans, and things too ruined to name. Varkul's magic coils through them without rest, stitching meat to bone, binding souls to broken bodies, and dragging fresh recruits from the piles with every passing moment.

The lich turns from his throne. His hollow gaze settles upon you.
"You have broken my road," he says, his voice dry as a tomb being opened.
"You have slain my servants. You have delayed the kingdom that waits beneath your feet."

The corpses around him begin to twitch.
"But all who stand against death eventually kneel within it."
Varkul raises one withered hand, and the throne hall answers.

Objective

Kill Varkul the Below-King.

Starting Conditions

The players can place themselves anywhere in the starting area when the adventure begins.

All doors are initially open.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 2+ upon completion and at least 2 Resurrection Boons remained.	-	-
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion and at least 1 Resurrection Boon remained.	-	-
★	Varkul the Below-King killed.	-	-

This adventure grants no rewards, as the campaign ends and the heroes retire afterwards.
Star results may only be relevant for certain Campaign Quests or personal satisfaction.

Special Mechanic - The Bone Garden

At the beginning of each round, the party may sacrifice a Resurrection Boon. If they do, immediately **destroy all bone piles** and distribute **15 damage** among any Orcs, Goblins, and enemy models using the regular Undead reference card.

Then place **two bone piles** on any empty designated bone-pile locations. The players choose where they are placed if multiple locations are still available. If no bone piles remain in the supply, use objective tokens instead; these count as bone piles for all purposes.

Bone piles are props and fully occupy their spaces. If neither bone piles nor objective tokens remain in the supply, skip any further placement.

After placing them, spawn one **Orc** with the **Zombies trait** adjacent to each bone pile currently on the board. If no Orc models remain in the supply, spawn **Goblins** with the **Zombies trait** instead. If no Goblin models remain either, spawn **Undead** instead. If none of these models remain in the supply, skip further spawns. You'll have your hands full enough.

If no adjacent space is available, place the model in the nearest available space.

Varkul loses 2 Health for each model spawned in this way.

A hero adjacent to a bone pile may spend **1 Stamina** to crush it. Remove the bone pile from the board.



Special Mechanic - The Below-King

Use the following table as the reference for **Varkul the Below-King** - he is a **bespoke boss**.

Varkhul has three phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Bone Armor, Dark Aura, Bone Shrapnel

Phase 2

Bone Armor, Curse Of Death, Delayed Death, Terrifying Wail

Phase 3

Create Abomination, Injuring Stab, Bone Shrapnel, Aura of Defiling
Add **Curse of Death** again when playing at **campaign difficulty 5+**.

Outro

Varkul the Below-King staggers beneath the final blow.

For a moment, the lich seems too ancient to die. His bones crack, but do not fall. His crown of blackened iron trembles upon his skull. The corpses around him reach out as if to hold their master together, but the magic binding them has begun to tear.

Then Varkul screams. Not in rage, but in disbelief.
Pale fire bursts from his ribs, his eyes, his jaw, and every rune carved into his dead flesh. The throne hall shakes as centuries of stolen power unravel at once. Corpses collapse in heaps. Bone piles spill apart. The black threads of necromancy snap and vanish, one by one, until the buried court of the Below-King is filled only with silence.

At last, Varkul falls before the dwarven throne he had stolen.
His crown rolls across the stone and comes to rest in a puddle of grave-filth.
The defiled magic leaves the world.

What was once a throne hall of kings, then a fortress of undeath, is now only a stinking grave beneath the earth. The dead lie still. The tunnels no longer whisper. The army that would have swallowed Drucavia is broken forever.

You have ended the war below.

And for the first time in many nights, the darkness beneath the realm feels empty.

Campaign End + Revenant Unlock

You have finished this campaign. Check which campaign quests you completed and gain their rewards for future campaign playthroughs.

Additionally, if this is the first time you have slain Varkul The Below-King, read the following text aloud:
As the last echoes fade, you notice movement near the far wall.
There, bound in rusted chains against a monument of skulls, hangs an undead warrior in ancient Drucavian armor. His body is withered, his eyes burn with corpse-light, yet no malice stirs in him. The chains that hold him are marked with Varkul's runes, and several have gone dark with the lich's death.

The warrior lifts his head.
"So," he whispers, "the Below-King is ash at last."
His voice is strained, but human grief still lives inside it.
"I was once sworn to Drucavia. I fought until my blood was gone, then bargained with darkness because I feared my duty was not finished. Varkul found me after that. He thought undeath made all things his."
The warrior looks at the fallen lich. "He was wrong."

The last chains break beneath your hands, and the undead warrior steps free. He does not kneel. He does not beg. He simply stands, bearing the weight of a soul that refused to rot.
"If your realm still has need of cursed blades and stubborn hearts," he says, "then I will walk again."
The Revenant has been freed.

Unlock the class **"Revenant"** for all future playthroughs.

